

Step 7: Business Licenses & Permits

Includes: Business License Checklist + Permit Tracker Worksheet + Resale Certificate Guide

Step-by-Step Guide

1. Check Local Requirements

- a. Contact your **city or county clerk's office** or check their website for "Business License" or "Occupational License."

2. Check State Requirements

- a. Visit your **State Department of Revenue** for sales tax permits / resale certificates.
- b. Contact your **State Licensing Board** for industry-specific licenses (healthcare, construction, cosmetology, finance, etc.).

3. Check Federal Requirements (if applicable)

- a. Use the SBA's guide: Apply for Licenses & Permits.
- b. Federal licensing applies only in regulated industries (alcohol, firearms, broadcasting, aviation, agriculture, transportation, etc.).

4. Apply + Pay Fees

- a. Expect fees ranging from \$25–\$1,000 depending on type and level of license.

5. Track and Renew

- a. Many licenses expire annually or biannually. Always track renewal deadlines.

Business License Checklist

Local Level

- ☐ General Business License (city/county)
- ☐ Zoning or Home Occupation Permit (if working from home)
- ☐ Health Department Permit (restaurants, food handling, healthcare)
- ☐ Fire Safety Inspection (for physical locations open to the public)

State Level

- ☐ Sales Tax Permit / Reseller's Permit / Resale Certificate
- ☐ Professional or Occupational License (contractors, barbers, healthcare, finance, legal, etc.)
- ☐ Environmental Permit (manufacturing, disposal, emissions, etc.)

Federal Level (only for regulated industries)

- ☐ Alcohol, Tobacco, Firearms (ATF)
- ☐ Federal Communications Commission (telecom, broadcasting)
- ☐ Department of Agriculture (food, meat, produce)
- ☐ Department of Transportation (trucking, shipping, logistics)

Permit Tracker Worksheet

License/Permit	Issuing Agency	Application Date	Fee	Approval Date	Expiration/Renewal Date	Notes
Business License	Local Clerk					Annual renewal
Reseller's Permit	State Dept. of Revenue					Track for tax filings
Contractor License	State Licensing Board					CE credits required
Federal Permit	Federal Agency					Biennial update

Resale Certificate Guide

Purpose

Allows a business to purchase inventory tax-free and collect sales tax from customers.

Universal Application Steps

1. Visit your **State Department of Revenue** website.
2. Search for “Resale Certificate,” “Sales Tax Permit,” or “Seller’s Permit.”
3. Complete application (common fields include):
 - a. Business legal name (must match your entity)
 - b. EIN (from Step 5)
 - c. Business type (retail, wholesale, e-commerce, service with product sales)
 - d. Estimated monthly/annual sales volume
4. Receive certificate or permit (instant download or mailed).

Best Practices

- Always keep a copy on file for vendors.
- Check whether renewal is required (varies by state).
- If selling online, research **economic nexus laws**: you may need multiple permits if sales exceed certain thresholds in other states.